Q+A

Breaking Boundaries

After playing a politician and policeman in recent outings, **Prosenjit Chatterjee** *gets a historical makeover in* Devi Chowdhurani

Q. What drew you to Prabhu Das, a suspended police officer, in *Maalik*?
I have played many cops in Bangla cinema, but what struck me was Pulkit's passion for crafting this character and the way he envisioned handling an action thriller—not your regular Bollywood treatment.

Q. First *Jubilee*, now *Khakee: The Bengal Chapter*. Are you having fun playing antagonists of late?
After *Khakee: The Bengal Chapter*, many director friends told me 'Dada, this was unexpected from you.' A negative character can command attention when it is smartly written and realistic.

Q. What can you tell us about *Devi Chowdhurani*, the period Bengali film coming out soon?
We're eyeing a Durga Puja release. I'm sure the film is going to cater to a wider national audience because of its subject. I play Bhavani Pathak, who is not just a character but a part of our history.

Q. If you ever do a full-fledged romance again, who is a director you would love to work with?
My first option would have been my friend, who is no longer with us: Rituparno Ghosh. But in any other language, my dream has always been to work with Mani Ratnam.

—with Poulomi Das

Photograph by **MANDAR DEODHAR**